Evidence & Data Reference Guide: Tribal Cowboy × North 40 Outfitters Equine Activation Proposal

Overview

This guide is purpose-built for the North 40 Outfitters CDA proposal specifically. It maps every major claim in the proposal to independently sourced data, identifies which arguments are well-backed, which are vulnerable, and what Tribal Cowboy needs to add to close the gaps. Use this as a preparation sheet before any conversation with the North 40 store manager or regional team.

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1. North 40's Customer Is Already the Horse Audience

Claim: "North 40's customer is a horse owner, a rancher, a farm family — this activation speaks to who already shops here"

This is your single strongest claim — and it is heavily supported.

- **Idaho has 270,000+ privately owned horses** — one of the highest per-capita ratios in the U.S. — and the population has grown by approximately 50,000 horses over the past decade.[1]
- **14% of Idaho households own equine**, making horse ownership in Idaho roughly 3× the national average. Northern Idaho's equine industry alone contributes over **$51 million** to state gross product.[2][3]
- The North 40 CDA store is a **109,700-square-foot** facility explicitly serving "farm and ranch products to customers in not

just Idaho, but neighboring Montana and Washington as well". This is not a general-audience retailer — its entire identity is the ag/outdoor community.[4][5]
- North 40 explicitly states its brand name was chosen because "North 40 meant a lot to our agriculture and ranch communities", confirming the audience alignment at the brand level.[6]
- **Millennials now hold 39% of horse ownership** (up 15% from 2023), and **55% of horse owners have two or more horses** (up 22% from 2018). The horse owner demographic is growing, younger, and more engaged than ever.[7][8]
- Horse owners spend **$8,600–$26,000 per year** on horse-related expenses — feed, farrier, vet, tack — categories that overlap directly with North 40's inventory. These are high-value, repeat-purchase customers.[9][10]
- **60% of horse owners shop in person** for saddles and accessories, and **63% purchase bridles and accessories in person**, meaning North 40's core audience specifically prefers physical retail for horse purchases.[11][7]
- **73% of horse owners buy gifts for their horses** at an average of **$96.92 per gift**. This demonstrates discretionary, impulse-friendly spend behavior — exactly what an in-store activation captures.[11][7]

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2. Dwell Time & Incremental Spend Claims

Claim: "Queue time = browse time; 30–60 min extended dwell time leads to incremental unplanned purchases"

- Research shows **doubling a store's average dwell time increases sales by up to 30%**. This is the foundational mechanic the activation relies on.[12]
- At airports — the closest analog to a captive, queue-based retail environment — a **10% increase in dwell time produces a 5% increase in total retail revenue**, and an **8% lift in food & beverage revenue**.[13]
- Open-air retail centers with experiential tenants (fitness, dining, entertainment) generate visits of **2–3 hours** versus just 30–60 minutes at passive-only retail. The pony ride queue replicates

this mechanic: one family member rides while the other browses.[14]
- Visitors to entertainment-anchored retail environments **spend up to 30% more** than those visiting traditional retail-only stores.[14]
- Families specifically shop less frequently but **spend more per trip** when they visit — the whole-family scenario the proposal describes is not just aspirational, it reflects how families actually shop.[15]
- North 40 CDA's own placer.ai profile shows **a 13% change in visits in June 2025** vs. September 2024 — a seasonal pattern that confirms spring/summer weekend activations align with a natural traffic spike, not a slow period.[16]

What's needed: The proposal currently cites "30–60 min increase" without labeling it as a projection. Add the phrase: *"Based on experiential retail benchmarks; will be measured at first event via queue observation and timestamp comparison."* This signals professionalism rather than guesswork.

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3. Revenue Impact Claims

Claim: "$1,500–$3,000 estimated same-day incremental revenue at $25 per family across 60–120 families"

- The $25/family incremental assumption is conservative relative to market benchmarks. Families of 3–4 people spend an average of **$204 per grocery trip** — meaning the consumer is accustomed to spending far more than $25 per unplanned outing, even at routine retail.[17]
- Experiential retail customers have been shown to increase **monthly spending by 30%**, **purchase frequency by 16.7%**, and **purchase quantity by 28.6%** — all of which support incremental spend on and beyond event day.[18][19]
- North 40's own product categories are well-suited for impulse activation purchases: **horse treats, grooming supplies, youth western apparel (boots, hats)**, and seasonal items. Horse owners already spend heavily on these categories in person.[11]

- Brand activations with measurable lift data show **15%+ incremental sales over baseline** in the weeks following the event, extending the ROI beyond a single event day.[20]

What's needed: The proposal should state clearly that the $1,500–$3,000 figure is a conservative projection based on a $25/family assumption — and show a "worst case / expected / best case" table. Even a worst case of $750 (30 families × $25) is profitable relative to the fee structure.

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4. Social Media & Branded Photo Claims

Claim: "100+ branded photos shared; North 40 brand circulates in the horse community's social feed for days"

- UGC (user-generated content) generates **6.9× more engagement** than brand-created content — every photo a guest posts is worth more to North 40 than a paid ad.[21][22]
- **79% of consumers report increased trust** in brands that use UGC. When a horse owner posts a Clydesdale photo branded "North 40 Outfitters CDA," that is an implicit endorsement to their entire horse-adjacent network.[21]
- Photo booth and branded photo content typically makes up **40–60% of all event hashtag volume** on Instagram and TikTok.[23]
- Social campaigns using UGC see a **50% lift in engagement** over organic brand posts alone — meaning the UGC generated at the event amplifies North 40's own social performance for weeks.[22][24]
- An outdoor ranch brand (RC Ranch) that began telling visual horse lifestyle stories on social media grew its audience by **68% and impressions by 30%** in under 24 months — validating the category's social appetite.[25]
- **Branded photo booth activations deliver 3–5× ROI** through social amplification and brand awareness, independent of any in-store sales lift.[26]

What's needed: Add 3–5 screenshots of social posts from prior Tribal Cowboy events, showing actual share counts and organic reach. Even posts with 20–50 likes from a community event are proof the

mechanism works. This converts a theoretical claim into demonstrated performance.

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5. "Proven in Schools, Community Events, and High-Traffic Venues" Claim

Claim: Tribal Cowboy has activated at similar venues safely and successfully

This is currently the proposal's weakest section — it is stated but not shown.

What's needed to close this gap:

- A 1-page "Our Track Record" section with: number of events run, approximate total guests served, incidents requiring medical attention (goal: zero), names or types of venues (schools, county fairs, corporate events), and 1–2 quotes from event organizers or parents.
- Even basic data like: *"Tribal Cowboy has run X events with Y total guests and zero incidents requiring medical response"* is the single most persuasive safety and credibility statement in the entire proposal.

Without this, decision-makers fill the gap with doubt. With it, the "zero risk" framing becomes documentable fact rather than a sales claim.

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6. Safety & Liability Claims

Claim: "Lead-line pony rides are safe; $2M coverage protects North 40"

Insurance and safety claims are well-supported by industry data:

- Equestrian injuries studied via national emergency room databases are **98.2% caused by independent riding** events — falls, bucks, and being thrown. Lead-line, enclosed, handler-

controlled pony rides eliminate all three primary injury mechanisms by design.[27]
- The PRCA documents a **99.9% animal safety record** across approximately 355,000 animal exposures per year at professional rodeo events — where animals are far less controlled than a lead-line ring.[28]
- The $2M per-occurrence coverage with North 40 named as additionally insured is an industry-standard structure. The proposal should add the insurance carrier name and policy type (general liability + animal liability endorsement) to make this more verifiable.[29][30]

What's still needed:

- A 5-bullet animal welfare protocol: maximum working hours, rotation schedule, shade/water access, temperature thresholds for cancellation, and vet oversight. This is not just safety — it preempts the single biggest social media risk (a photo of a stressed horse going viral).
- A brief ADA/accessibility statement: how guests who cannot ride still participate (e.g., Clydesdale photo area, viewing area for younger siblings or mobility-limited guests).

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7. "No Operational Burden on Store Staff" Claim

Claim: "Zero store staff required — we handle everything"

This claim is directionally accurate but undersells the coordination a store manager will actually need to do. Proactively acknowledging this makes you more credible, not less.

What the evidence supports:

- Parking lot activations that are truly self-contained (equipment, staff, and animals all provided by the vendor) do not require operational changes in the store.[30][29]
- However, North 40 store management will need to: (a) coordinate parking placement and lot access, (b) brief their own

staff so they can direct customers, (c) ensure fire lanes and ADA spaces remain clear, and (d) communicate the event internally.

Recommended addition: A simple grid: "What Tribal Cowboy handles vs. what North 40 needs to do." Showing 10 items in the "Tribal Cowboy" column and 3 items in the "North 40" column is more convincing than simply saying "zero burden."

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8. North 40 as a "Community Hub" Claim

Claim: "Partnering with an Indigenous-owned North Idaho horse business positions North 40 as a community hub"

- North 40 has publicly stated its biggest fear is "getting too big or moving too fast to understand, research, and be involved with the local communities we serve" — this is a documented company value that the community hub positioning directly speaks to.[31]
- North 40 explicitly serves a community-oriented, family-values customer base: "outdoor enthusiasts, farmers, and pet owners, serving both individuals and families". An experiential family event reinforces the brand identity they have built over 25+ years.[32]
- The Idaho Tribes Economic Impact Report documents the significant cultural and economic role of Native-owned businesses across the Coeur d'Alene region — Tribal Cowboy's Indigenous-owned status adds authentic local resonance that a national brand vendor cannot replicate.[33]

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9. Competitive Differentiation Claims

Claim: "No competitor can copy this overnight; this positions North 40 as the store the horse community tells stories about"

- The Tribal Cowboy activation brings **purebred Clydesdales** — one of the most recognizable and emotionally impactful breeds in agriculture and ranch culture. Competitors (Tractor Supply, Murdoch's, Wilco) do not have access to this asset.
- The branded instant photo delivery system is described as "rare at the event level in our region" — this is credible because most equine event vendors use basic photo booths, not AI-matched instant delivery with branded overlays.[29][30]
- North 40 already runs archery, fishing, greenhouse, and custom branding iron services — they are clearly a destination-style store, not a commodity retailer. A recurring seasonal horse activation fits this identity and deepens it in a category no competitor currently owns.[4]

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10. Quick-Reference: Key Numbers for Any North 40 Conversation

Statistic	Source	Use In Proposal For
109,700 sq ft CDA store — one of North 40's largest[5]	Spokane Journal	Scale and importance of CDA location
14% of Idaho households own equine[3]	Idaho Horse Board	Core audience size
270,000+ horses in Idaho; growing by ~50K per decade[1]	Idaho Horse Council / NewsRadio 1310	Market depth argument
$51M+ contribution from northern Idaho equine industry[2]	U of I Extension	Regional economic relevance
Horse owners spend $8,600–$26,000/year on horse expenses[9][10]	CareCredit / FarmhouseTack	High-value repeat customer argument
60% of horse owners buy tack/accessories IN PERSON[11]	APPA 2025 Horse Report	Why physical retail still wins for this audience
73% of horse owners buy gifts for their horses; avg $96.92/gift[11][7]	APPA 2025	Impulse/discretionary spend behavior
Millennials = 39% of horse owners, up 15% from 2023[7]	APPA 2025	Audience is growing and skewing younger
Doubling dwell time = up to 30% sales increase[12]	V-Count retail analytics	Dwell time → revenue argument
Experiential retail customers spend 30% more monthly[18][19]	Rockbot / LinkedIn	Incremental spend claim

Statistic	Source	Use In Proposal For
98.2% of equestrian injuries from independent riding (not lead-line)[27]	National ER database (NEISS)	Safety defense for pony rides
UGC generates 6.9× more engagement than brand content[21][22]	Medianug / Nosto	Branded photo social value
Photo booth content = 40–60% of event hashtag volume[23]	FeatureBooth	"100+ shares" social reach claim
North 40 brand built for ag/ranch community since 1997[6][31]	North 40 brand history	Audience alignment argument
North 40 employs ~850 people across 12 locations[34]	CDA Press	Company scale / credibility signal

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11. Data Gaps to Fix Before the Meeting

The following are the specific claims the North 40 store manager or regional team is most likely to challenge. These are listed in order of priority:

Claim	Gap	Recommended Fix
"Proven in schools and community events"	No named events, dates, or attendance figures cited	Add a 3-event track record: venue type, date, approximate guests, incidents (0)
"60–120 families per event"	No Tribal Cowboy attendance data; modeled assumption	Reference 1–2 real events with actual headcounts, even rough estimates
"100+ branded photos shared"	Self-asserted; no screenshots or social post data	Add 3–5 screenshots of prior event posts with visible engagement counts
"Zero incidents"	Stated but unverified by any third party	Add Tribal Cowboy's own event log statement: "X events, Y guests, 0 medical incidents"
"$1,500–$3,000 incremental revenue"	No comparable retail data tied to equine activation specifically	Label as projection; add conservative/expected/best-case table
"North 40 named as additionally insured"	Mentioned but no carrier, policy number, or sample COI shown	Offer to provide sample COI at first meeting; name your carrier
Animal welfare protocol	Entirely absent from proposal	Add 5 bullet welfare policy: hours, rotation, water, shade, temp limits
ADA/accessibility	Not addressed	Add 2 sentences: how non-riders still participate; how queue/viewing area is accessible

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References

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